



#### △ CHANGING STYLE

The original Carolingian domed chapel, its roof replaced after a fire in 1656, is nestled between the cathedral's Gothic tower (left), added around 1350, and the 14th-century Gothic chancel.



#### △ EMBELLISHED DOORKNOCKER

This is one of two lion's head doorknockers from Aachen's Carolingian "Wolf Doors." The doors were modeled on Roman temple doors and were cast around 800 CE for the Palatine Chapel.

#### ◁ EMPEROR'S SHRINE

A gold-and-silver casket containing Charlemagne's remains, commissioned by the Holy Roman Emperor Frederick II in 1215, is enclosed in glass at the center of Aachen's Gothic chancel, built in 1355-1414.

**30 kings and  
12 queens were  
crowned at  
Aachen between  
936 and 1531**



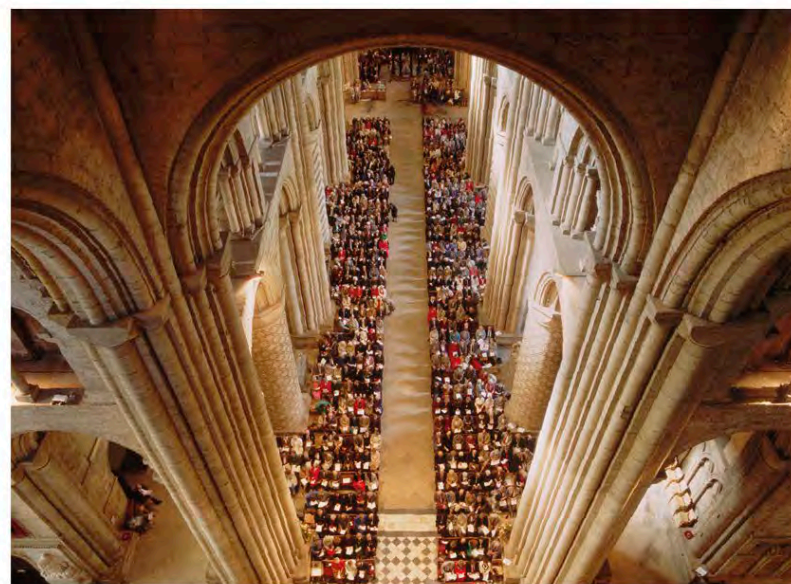
# Durham Cathedral

*One of the finest surviving examples  
of Gothic architecture in Britain*

Durham Cathedral was begun in 1093, less than 30 years after the Norman Conquest, and completed around 1133. It was built to house the shrine of St. Cuthbert (who spread Christianity in the north of England in the 7th century) and the tomb of the scholar and theologian the Venerable Bede (673–735 CE). The cathedral is the most complete example of Norman architecture in Britain, having retained its original Norman nave, choir, and transepts.

#### Innovative design

The cathedral is characterized by its solidity, sense of order and proportion, and semicircular arches and vaults built in the Romanesque style. However, the nave also features the world's first structural pointed arch—a feature that came to define Gothic architecture in the mid-12th century. The innovative use of stone ribs to form pointed arches—which provided additional support and superior weight distribution—allowed the cathedral's masons to build what is the largest surviving stone-vaulted ceiling from the period. A working church and popular attraction, the cathedral—along with Durham Castle—became a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1986.



#### △ STURDY SUPPORT

Solid Romanesque columns support the choir's circular arches and lead to the Chapel of Nine Altars and the rose window. The chapel was built in 1242-1290 to accommodate increasing numbers of pilgrims to St. Cuthbert's shrine.